

Mission 2020

The Indian government plans to increase the forest area in India, and take in up to 6.3 per cent of the country's emissions

Greenest Tech company

So what is the Greenest tech company? Cisco top's Greenpeace's list, while Newsweek gives the honour to HP

Digital Life



The Jacaranda with its characteristic flowers

The Digit Tree Project

Calculating and offsetting your personal carbon footprint can be a daunting task. We demystify the calculations for you, and give you a simple solution as well

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The green fever isn't a new phenomenon. Everyone from the Hollywood stars to popular politicians want to be part of it. India in comparison hasn't jumped on that bandwagon just yet – mostly because we are a pretty environmentally friendly country to begin with. Technology, even the basics such as telephonic connectivity and electricity are still to reach some rural areas. Apart from gases emitted by wheat and rice farms, as well as animals such as cows, the carbon footprint of India is lower than the more

developed countries. However, that does not mean that we can absolve ourselves of all responsibility towards the environment. Whether we like it or not, we are stuck with technology that is harmful to the environment, and the simplest way to offset the damage is to plant trees. A

Resources

These sites were used for the calculations
www.begreennow.com
www.carbonfootprint.com
www.erasecarbonfootprint.com
www.michaelbluejay.com
www.sourcemap.org

lot of information has been collected on the processes that go into making technology, and the patterns of the usage of this technology. However, a lot of confusion in measuring or calculating the extent of the damage technology use causes to the environment remains. Measuring the methods used to offset this damage is also problematic. This is our attempt to distill the wealth of information, into something that is clear and simple.



How is environmental damage calculated?

The major concern of environmentalists is a phenomenon known as global warming. Global warming is a by product of the emission of greenhouse gases into the atmosphere. The major culprit here is carbon dioxide (CO₂). CO₂ traps excess heat in the atmosphere, by not allowing heat to bounce off the surface of the earth and escape into space. There are scientists who claim that global warming is not happening at all, or is a natural part of longer cycles of the weather, that we have not yet fully understood. Additionally, there is plenty of evidence that suggests that greenhouse gases are actually good for plant life (that's why it is called a greenhouse gas in the first place). However, our industrial-technological society is harming or at least changing the environment (at least around the urban areas) and CO₂ is a convenient unit to measure this impact. CO₂ emissions are easy to calculate, and it is also possible to reduce all activity to the amount of CO₂ released into the atmosphere. CO₂ emissions are a global unit used to calculate greenhouse gas emissions. This unit is called a "carbon credit". A single carbon credit is one ton of CO₂ in the atmosphere, or equivalent greenhouse gases or any other process used in an environmentally damaging activity. The monetary value of a carbon credit changes depending on the location. Basically, it is the amount of money needed to set up something that can absorb one carbon credit. About the only effective absorber of CO₂ from the atmosphere is a tree, which is why we are